the count of all tasks of type “bug” or “defect” by completion date.

Usually you want to see the exact opposite from bug creation and bug completion; it’s good when bugs are getting squashed—that means bug completion is high. It’s bad when you’re generating a lot of bugs—that means bug creation is high. Let’s take a look at bug completion in the scope of the big picture. Figure 3.11 is an aggregate of bugs, volume, and story points, the data that we’ve collected and put together so far.

Figure 3.11. Bugs, volume, and estimates tracked together

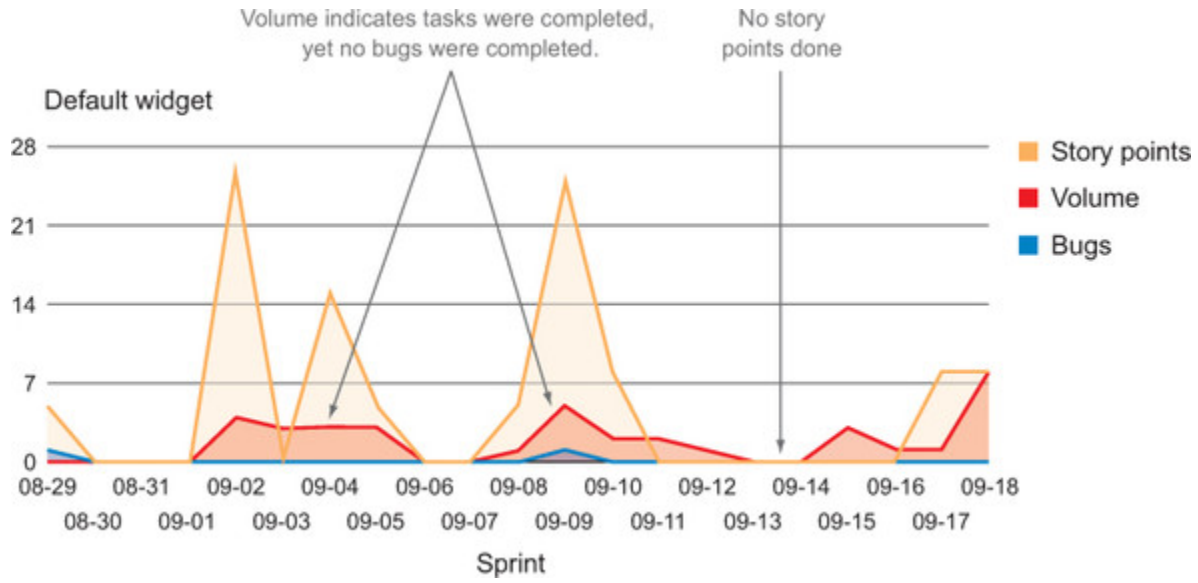


Figure 3.11 shows that this team doesn’t output many bugs, and estimates and volume seem to be fairly closely aligned, which at a glance is pretty good. But there are some instances where volume shows that work is being completed, but no points are associated with those tasks and no bugs are completed at the same time. This shows that the team is picking up unplanned work, which is bad because:

- It’s not budgeted for.
- It impacts in a negative way the deliverables the team committed to.

Notice how around 09-11 even though volume shows work is getting completed, no story points are completed. This is a great example of how unplanned work can hurt the deliverables that a team commits to. After